

ADMINISTRATIVE POLICY

CHAPTER ONE

POLICY FRAMEWORK

Introduction

Administrative policy refers to a set of **rules, principles, and guidelines** established by Ruralnet ICT academy to direct and regulate its **internal operations, management, and decision-making processes**. It is the **framework that guides how things should be done** at ruralnet to ensure order, efficiency, and accountability during daily operations by both management, staff and students/clients.

By using this manual, Ruralnet ICT Academy whill be able to successfully;

Manage its resources (human, financial, physical, and technological)

- Deliver its services
- Maintain discipline and performance
- Ensure compliance with laws and institutional standards

Our policy scope

The table below gives our manual scope summary

Component	Focus Area
Policy Framework	Purpose, vision, scope
Governance	Management structure
Human Resource	Staffing, conduct, development
Academic Administration	Teaching, exams, curriculum
Student Affairs	Admission, welfare, discipline
ICT Infrastructure	Systems, labs, security
Finance & Procurement	Budgeting, purchases, accountability
Quality Assurance	Evaluation, accreditation
Health & Safety	Safety and environmental policies
Communication	PR, feedback, information sharing
Library & Learning	Academic resource management
Research & Industry Links	Innovation and collaboration
Monitoring & Review	Evaluation and improvement

Name and Aim

Ruralnet ICT Academy (RICT) is an institution aimed at providing ICT education to the rural population located in Siaya County in a town called Ugunja along Busia-Kisumu highway, as well distant people through online training. The Academy aims to bridge the digital divide between rural and urban areas by offering high-quality training to the rural population. The Academy offers a range of courses, including computer basics, web design, programming, digital marketing, data analysis and KASNEB courses.

▲ **Vision and Vision Statement**

—Vision

Ruralnet ICT Academy's (RICT)'s vision is bridging the digital gap between the rural and urban areas.

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⚡ **Mission statement**

Ruralnet ICT Academy's (Our mission is to understand what our students and businesses hope to achieve and dedicate our computer training and development to the fulfillment of those goals. The computer training provided is contributing visibly and substantially to the fulfillment of our area business's strategies.

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The Academy provides a rewarding work environment and fair compensation to our employees; ultimately provide excellent value to our customers and a fair return to our owners.

ision is bridging the digital gap between the rural and urban areas.

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• **Objectives**

The Ruralnet ICT Academy knows firsthand that computer training has to meet all of its customers' needs in order to have a tangible lasting impact. When you measure across multiple customer segments—each of which has its own priorities—you see how much more training must do to consistently and simultaneously satisfy participants, managers, and executives. Training then can move to close those gaps and deliver more real values. Closing those gaps between employer skill needs, employee and learner skills development is the main objective of our institution.

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Policy objectives

Guidance

Administrative policy provides clear direction to both **administrators and staff** on how to perform their duties effectively. This includes guidelines on teaching procedures, managing computer labs, handling student data, and maintaining professional conduct.

Uniformity

It ensures **consistency in operations and decision-making** across the entire institution. Uniformity means that all departments — such as networking, programming, and database

management — follow the same administrative rules for attendance, grading, communication, and use of ICT resources.

Accountability

Administrative policies make individuals and departments **answerable for their actions and performance**. This ensures that Instructors, Accountants, and administrators perform their duties responsibly — such as maintaining ICT resources, marking assignments on time, and using college funds properly.

Control

Policies help **maintain discipline and order** by setting clear rules and boundaries. This involves regulating the use of computers, internet access, and software licenses, as well as enforcing codes of conduct for both staff and students.

Efficiency

Administrative policies aim to **simplify processes and improve productivity**. Efficiency can mean smoother operations — like automated student registration, digital record keeping, or organized scheduling of labs and classes.

Legal and regulatory framework

The Computer Society of Kenya

Ruralnet ICT registered with Computer Society of Kenya (CSK) in 2017 and was granted full accreditation for offering ICT Courses, ranging from basic courses to advanced ones.

CSK certificate/membership number is 007569

Cisco Networking Academy

Certified Cisco Networking Academy ID: 48943725

Kenya Accountants and Secretaries National Examinations Board (KASNEB)

On 2nd October 2025, KASNEB board sent an investigative team to conduct assessment and institutional evaluation. The exercise took place and the collected information were presented to the KASNEB board for approval.

Ruralnet ICT Academy is currently waiting for approval and interim accreditation by the KASNEB board.

Technical and Vocational Education and Training Authority

Ruralnet ICT Academy is preparing to host TVETA official for college evaluation and assessment anytime once the required documentations are ready.

Scope and applicability

This policy manual is and shall always be applicable by any person attached temporarily and permanently at Ruralnet ICT Academy.

The policy contains instructions and procedures of activities academically and professionally for both students/clients and employee/staff.

CHAPTER TWO

GOVERNANCE AND INSTITUTIONAL STRUCTURE

Governance

RuralNet ICT Academy is organized into a hierarchy with top, middle and operational management levels. The company has various departments which assist in the delivery of quality services to the clients.

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2.3.1 Top Management

This level of management consists of an organization's chief executive or managing director. It is the ultimate source of power and authority, since it oversees the goals, policies, and procedures of the company. Some roles and responsibilities of the top management can be summarized as follows:

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- Laying down the objectives and broad policies of the business enterprise.
- Issuing necessary instructions for the preparation of department-specific programs, schedules, [and](#) procedures, [among other set](#).
- Preparing strategic plans and policies for the organization.

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- Appointing the employees for middle-level management, i.e. [Departmental](#) managers.

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Establishing controls of all organizational departments. Strategic planning and execution of the overall business success.

2.3.2 Middle Level of Management

The Departmental managers form this middle management level. These people are directly accountable to top management for the functioning of their respective departments, devoting more time to organizational and directional functions. Some of their roles are;

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~~1. Executing the plans of the organization in accordance with the policies and directives laid out by the top management level.~~

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● Executing the plans of the organization in accordance with the policies and directives laid out by the top management level

- Forming plans for the sub-units of the organization that they supervise
- Participating in the hiring and training processes of lower-level management.
- Interpreting and explaining the policies from top-level management to lower-level management.
- Sending reports and data to top management in a timely and efficient manner.

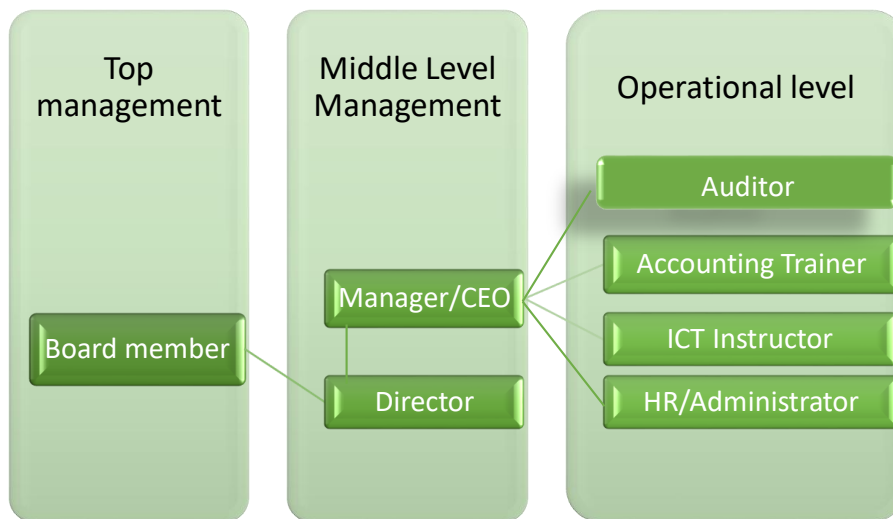
2.3.3 Operational Level of Management

This level consists of operational employees whose job is to complete tasks assigned by the manager. They include ICT instructors, Technicians and marketing personnel.

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Organizational structure



* 2.6 Duties and responsibilities

1. Board Member

Duties/Responsibilities:

- Ensuring all assets are used prudently.
- Ensuring all decisions are made in the best interests of the organization and help it move closer to its mission.
- Ensuring the organization abides by all laws and regulations, as well as its own By-laws.
- Strategic governance and oversight.

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- Serving the organization's stakeholders.
- Managing budgets.
- Setting policies.
- Overseeing personnel.
- Setting goals.
- Measuring goals and achievements.

2. **Director/Academy Manager~~Conducts performance evaluations that are timely and constructive~~**

- Reviews existing training programs; suggests enhancements and modifications to improve engagement, learning, and retention and/or to meet the changing needs of clientele, the organization, or the industry
- Ensures that training materials and programs are current, accurate, and effective. Maintains knowledge of new methods and techniques for training, and training requirements applicable to the organization and/or industry
- Identifies problems and opportunities such as operational changes or industry developments that training could improve.
- Conducts or facilitates required and recommended training sessions.
- Collaborates with vendors and third-party training providers to arrange employee registration for and participation in outside training programs.
- Ensures that training milestones and goals are met while adhering to approved training budget.
- Prepares and implements training budget.
- Performs other related duties as assigned.

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4.3. ICT instructors/IT consultant/ICT technician

- Design, facilitate and teach the computer instruction component
- Assess, supervise, and motivate students
- Evaluating student work and progress
- Prepare and execute lesson plans
- Develop course syllabus
- Assigning tasks
- Install, configure, and maintain computer hardware, software, and peripheral devices.
- Set up and manage local and wide area networks (LAN/WAN)
- Monitor and troubleshoot hardware, software, and network issues.
- Perform regular system updates, backups, and data recovery operations.
- Configure and secure routers, switches, firewalls, and Wi-Fi access points.
- Provide technical support and user assistance for ICT systems.
- Manage and administer servers, email systems, and user accounts.
- Implement cybersecurity measures to protect data and systems.
- Conduct ICT audits and recommend system improvements.
- Develop and enforce ICT policies, standards, and procedures.
- Maintain records of ICT assets, licenses, and configurations.

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- Manage institutional websites, online portals, and databases.
- Offer advice on ICT solutions, procurement, and system upgrades.
- Conduct staff or client training on ICT tools and best practices.
- Participate in ICT project planning, budgeting, and implementation.
- Research and recommend emerging technologies to improve efficiency.
- Ensure compliance with data protection and ICT security regulations.
- Maintain and service ICT infrastructure (servers, UPS, cabling, etc.).
- Liaise with vendors and service providers for ICT-related contracts.
- Prepare periodic ICT performance reports and documentation

Core Competencies

- Creative and innovative.
- Strong problem-solving and analytical skills.
- Excellent communication and teamwork.
- Attention to detail and documentation accuracy.
- High integrity, professionalism, and confidentiality.

Professional qualifications

- Degree/Diploma/Certificate holder in ICT/Computer science/ICT technician, software engineering
- Academic credentials from recognized institution and official exam bodies such as KASNEB, KNEC, CDACC, CSK

3.4. Administrator/HR

- Manage budgets, logistics and events or meetings
- Handle scheduling, record-keeping and reporting
- Ensure the school complies with relevant laws and regulations
- Develop and run educational programs
- Hire, train and advise staff
- Counsel students when needed
- Resolve conflicts and other issues
- Communicate with parents, regulatory bodies and the public
- Have a hand in the creation of the school curriculum
- Implement actions that improve the school and the quality of education (e.g. building renovations, new guidelines for students, new subjects)
- Check for any information in the institution's communication channels such as messages and managing incoming/outgoing messages. ~~Help shape and uphold the vision of the school~~

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Professional qualifications

- Degree/Diploma/Certificate in HR/Secretarial/Business administration/Business management/Public Relations/Customer Service & front office/Records & Information Management/Computerized office applications/Supervisory management & Leadership/Human Resource Information Systems (HRIS)/Project Management

Core Competencies

- Ability to communicate clearly, professionally, and effectively.
- Strong ability to plan, prioritize, and manage multiple tasks efficiently.
- Handling sensitive information discreetly and maintaining ethical standards.
- Accuracy in data entry, documentation, and correspondence.
- Professional and courteous interaction with clients, employees, and stakeholders.
- Meeting deadlines, managing schedules, and maintaining productivity.
- Working effectively with colleagues across departments.
- Ability to identify, analyze, and resolve issues efficiently.
- Skilled in Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook) and office equipment use.
- Demonstrating reliability, accountability, and a positive attitude.

4.5. Accounting trainer

- Develop, review, and update course syllabi to meet KASNEB and institutional requirements.
- Align course content with current accounting standards (IFRS, IAS, IPSAS, GAAP).
- Prepare lesson plans, schemes of work, and teaching materials (slides, notes, case studies).
- Integrate practical examples, simulations, and case studies in lessons to enhance understanding.
- Conduct interactive lectures, tutorials, and workshops for students pursuing **CAM, ATD, CPA, FCPA, or CIFA**.
- Teach **financial accounting, management accounting, taxation, auditing, financial management, and business law**, among others.
- Use modern teaching tools (e.g., Excel, QuickBooks, Sage, Tally, or Power BI) for applied learning.
- Incorporate **data analysis techniques** (Excel, SPSS, Python, or Power BI) where relevant to financial analytics.
- Offer extra remedial sessions to weak students or exam re-sitters.
- Prepare, administer, and mark class tests, assignments, term papers, and mock exams.
- Evaluate student performance, track progress, and provide constructive feedback.

- Design practical tasks or mini-projects that test both theory and practical competence.
- Prepare students for **professional exams (KASNEB)** and monitor exam pass rates.\
- Provide academic and career guidance to learners in accounting and finance fields.
- Mentor students on professional ethics, workplace conduct, and continuous professional development.
- Advise students on exam registration, progression paths, and specialization (e.g., audit, tax, financial management).
- Encourage use of online learning resources and professional networks.
- Maintain accurate records of student attendance, performance, and exam results.
- Submit periodic teaching reports and exam analyses to management.
- Participate in departmental meetings, academic boards, and curriculum review committees.
- Assist in planning and coordinating training timetables or examination schedules.
- Stay updated with changes in accounting standards, taxation laws, and financial regulations.
- Attend workshops, seminars, and CPD programs organized by KASNEB or other professional bodies.
- Participate in institutional research, publications, and consultancy activities.
- Support marketing and outreach programs to promote accounting and data courses.
- Train students on **data-driven decision-making** using Excel, SQL, Python, or Power BI.
- Demonstrate use of accounting software (QuickBooks, Sage, Tally, or Zoho Books).
- Integrate ICT and e-learning tools (Google Classroom, Zoom, MS Teams, or Moodle).
- Evaluate and implement digital teaching aids for improved student engagement.
- Promote integrity, confidentiality, and ethical behavior in teaching and assessment.
- Model professional standards consistent with accounting body codes of conduct
- Uphold fairness and transparency in student evaluation and communication.

Core Competencies

- Strong knowledge of accounting and finance principles.
- Excellent presentation, communication, and mentoring skills.
- Competency in accounting software and analytical tools.
- Ability to link theory with real-world business applications.
- Familiarity with **KASNEB curriculum** and exam structure.

Qualifications

Academic Qualifications

1. **Diploma or Bachelor's Degree** in any of the following fields (or equivalent):
 - Accounting
 - Finance

- Commerce (BCom)
- Business Administration (Accounting/Finance option)
- Economics
- Data Analytics / Statistics (for data-related modules)

Professional Qualifications

The trainer should possess **at least one** of the following recognized professional certifications:

Level	Professional Qualification	Requirement
Certificate & Diploma Trainers (CAM / ATD)	- CPA Section 4 and above - ATD Finalist - Diploma in Accounting or Finance (KNEC or equivalent)	Must have sufficient practical knowledge in bookkeeping, costing, and financial systems.
Professional Course Trainers (CPA / FCPA / CIFA)	- Certified Public Accountant (CPA-K) – Fully qualified - Certified Investment and Financial Analyst (CIFA-K) - Fellow Certified Public Accountant (FCPA) – for advanced or senior-level training	Registration with a professional body (e.g., ICPAK) is essential.
Data Analysis Trainers (Finance-oriented)	- Certification in Data Analysis / Data Analytics / Business Intelligence tools (e.g., Excel, Power BI, Python, SPSS, R). - Additional qualifications like Certified Data Analyst (CDA) or Microsoft Data Analyst Associate are added advantages.	Should be able to integrate analytics with accounting data.

Technical and ICT Skills

- Proficiency in **MS Office Suite** (Excel, PowerPoint, Word).
- Hands-on experience in **accounting software** (QuickBooks, Tally, Sage, or ERP systems).
- Familiarity with **data tools** like Power BI, SPSS, R, or Python (for analytics courses).
- Knowledge of **online teaching tools** (Zoom, Google Classroom, MS Teams, Moodle).

Soft Skills and Competencies

- Excellent **communication** and **presentation** skills.
- Strong **analytical** and **problem-solving** ability.

- Passion for teaching, mentorship, and continuous learning.
- High ethical standards and integrity.
- Ability to simplify complex accounting and finance concepts.
- Commitment to student success and professional development.

CHAPTER THREE

HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT/

Recruitment and appointment procedures

This section ensures transparency, fairness, and merit-based selection when hiring academic, technical, and administrative staff.

Objectives;

- Transparency and fairness,
- Based on merit and qualifications,
- Alignment with the institution's goals, policies, and legal framework.

Scope

- Applies to all categories of employees in the at Ruralnet ICT Academy:

Guiding Principles

- Recruitment must adhere to the following principles:
- No discrimination based on gender, age, religion, ethnicity, or disability, race or color.
- Candidates must meet the required qualifications and competencies.
- The process should be open and competitive.
- All decisions must be documented and justifiable.
- Must follow labour laws, institutional guidelines and regulations.

Recruitment Process

a. *Staffing Needs Identification*

- Department heads identify vacant positions or new staffing requirements.
- A justification memo is submitted to the Administrator/HR.
- The request specifies:
 - Job title and description,
 - Qualifications required,
 - Reason for recruitment (replacement/new post),
 - Duration (permanent, contract, part-time).

b. *Approval to recruit*

- The Manager/CEO reviews and discusses the request.
- Once approved, HR prepares a **Recruitment Plan** (timeline, budget, selection panel).

c. *Job advertisement*

- Vacancies are advertised publicly through, website, social media or LinkedIn job portal.
- Each advert includes:
 - Job title, duties, and responsibilities,
 - Minimum qualifications and experience,
 - Application procedure and deadline,
 - Equal opportunity statement.

d. *Receipt and Shortlisting of Applications*

- HR receives all applications and compiles a list.
- The **Administrator and Manager** shortlists candidates based on advertised qualifications.
- A **shortlisting report** is prepared and signed by the CEO

e. *Shortlisting and interviews*

- Shortlisted candidates are invited for interviews.
- Selection methods may include:
 - Oral interviews,
 - Practical/technical tests (for ICT and technical positions),
 - Teaching demonstrations (for lecturers),
 - Aptitude or written tests (for administrative posts).
- Each candidate is scored using a standard evaluation form.
- CEO recommends the most suitable candidate(s).

f. Approval and Appointment

- Interview results are submitted to the CEO for approval.
- Successful candidates receive **formal appointment letters**, stating:
 - Position title,
 - Terms of service (permanent, contract, probationary),
 - Salary and benefits,
 - Reporting date.
- Unsuccessful candidates are notified respectfully.

g. Orientation and Induction

- New staff undergo an induction program covering:
 - Institutional mission, vision, and policies,
 - Job expectations and performance evaluation,
 - Code of conduct and ethics,
 - Health, safety, and ICT systems orientation.

Probation and Confirmation

- New employees serve a **probation period** of 1 month
- During probation:
 - Supervisors/CEO evaluate performance and conduct.
 - HR conducts progress reviews.
- Upon satisfactory performance, the staff member is **confirmed** in employment through a written confirmation letter.

Records and Documentation

- HR/Administrator maintains a file for each employee containing:
 - Application materials,
 - Interview records,
 - Appointment letters,
 - Performance appraisals,
 - Contract renewals or termination records.

Recruitment of Part-Time and Accounting trainers

- Part-time lecturers may be engaged when:
 - Accounting courses' students are enrolled,
 - The Institution requires a trainer in Video editing and auditions,
 - There is an increased teaching workload.
- They are appointed on **fixed-term contracts** specifying teaching hours, subjects, and remuneration.
- Must meet the same minimum qualifications as full-time lecturers.

Promotion and Internal Recruitment

- Internal candidates may be considered for higher positions based on:
 - Experience, performance, and qualifications.
 - Vacancy availability and recommendation from the supervisor.
- Promotion follows a similar transparent process as external recruitment.

Review of Recruitment Policy

The recruitment and appointment policy should be reviewed every **3 years** or whenever legal or institutional changes occur.

Staff Code of Conduct and Ethics for Ruralnet ICT Academy

Objective

To promote ethical behavior, professionalism, and integrity among all staff members of the ICT College, ensuring that the institution maintains high moral and professional standards in delivering education and services.

Guiding Ethical Principles

All staff are expected to demonstrate:

1. **Integrity:** Honesty and consistency in actions and decisions.

2. **Accountability:** Taking responsibility for one's actions and performance.
3. **Professionalism:** Maintaining competence, courtesy, and respect in all duties.
4. **Confidentiality:** Protecting institutional and personal information.
5. **Respect:** Upholding dignity and diversity among students and colleagues.
6. **Impartiality:** Avoiding favoritism, discrimination, or bias.
7. **Commitment:** Dedication to Ruralnet's mission and continuous improvement.

General Conduct Expectations

All staff must:

- Observe **official working hours** and perform assigned duties diligently.
- Dress **appropriately and decently** while on duty.
- Maintain **discipline, punctuality, and reliability**.
- Avoid **negligence, absenteeism, or lateness** without valid reason.
- Foster teamwork and a positive institutional image.
- Adhere to **institutional rules, national laws, and TVET guidelines**.
- Staff are expected to report to work and classes **on time**.
- Absence must be communicated in advance and supported by valid reasons.
- Repeated absenteeism or lateness may lead to **disciplinary action**.
- Use institutional funds and resources responsibly.
- Record and report all financial transactions accurately.
- Avoid misuse of assets or embezzlement.
- Follow approved procurement and financial procedures.

Professional Ethics for Academic Staff/Trainers

Teaching staff shall:

- Prepare adequately and deliver lessons effectively.
- Use teaching aids, ICT/Accounting tools, and methods that enhance learning.
- Treat students fairly, equally, and respectfully.
- Refrain from any form of **harassment, favoritism, or discrimination**.
- Maintain **academic integrity** — no falsification of grades or records.
- Protect **student confidentiality** (personal and academic information).
- Avoid plagiarism and promote honesty in research and assignments.
- Mentor students and encourage innovation and ethical ICT practice.
- Maintain **professional relationships** with students and colleagues.
- Avoid any form of **sexual harassment, intimidation, or exploitation**.
- Promote mutual respect, cooperation, and inclusivity.
- Avoid gossip, defamation, or spreading false information.

Use of ICT Facilities and Resources

Staff must:

- Use ICT facilities (computers, internet, email, systems) **for official and academic purposes only**.
- Avoid misuse such as:
 - Unauthorized data access or alteration,
 - Downloading or sharing illegal or obscene content,
 - Installing unlicensed software.
- Protect college data and systems from viruses and cyber threats.
- Keep login credentials and passwords confidential.
- Report ICT security breaches immediately.

7. Conflict of Interest

Staff must avoid situations where personal interests conflict with college duties.

Examples include:

- Favoring relatives or friends in hiring, grading, or procurement.
- Using institutional resources for personal gain.
- Accepting gifts, bribes, or favors that could influence decisions.

All potential conflicts must be declared in writing to the CEO through Admin/HR Office.

Confidentiality and Data Protection

- Staff must not disclose confidential information about:
 - Students, staff, or institutional matters.
 - Financial, academic, or administrative records.
- Confidential data may only be shared with **authorized persons** for official purposes.
- All staff must comply with the **Data Protection Act** and institutional ICT policies.

Prohibited Behaviors

The following are strictly prohibited:

- Corruption, bribery, or fraud.
- Discrimination or harassment (sexual, verbal, physical).
- Drunkenness or substance abuse while on duty.
- Unauthorized use of college property.
- Falsification of records or documents.
- Unauthorized absence from duty.
- Leaking examination materials or confidential data.

Disciplinary Actions

Every staff member must **read, understand, and sign** a **Code of Conduct Declaration Form** upon appointment. Signing indicates agreement to comply with all institutional policies and ethical standards.

Violation of this Code shall result in disciplinary measures, which may include:

- Written warning,
- Suspension,
- Demotion,
- Dismissal

All disciplinary actions will follow due process.

Reporting Misconduct

- Staff are expected to report any issue to the Administrator/HR who will provide appropriate advice. If the issue is beyond her office to handle, she shall forward the matter to the Manager/CEO
- All students must report their grievances/issues to their immediate trainer.
- In case the issue involves trainer and a student, Administrator may step in to offer solution. Student still allowed to report to HR in this matter.
- Issues regarding lending and borrowing between students, staff and student-staff shall not be handled in the institution's office.
- Any deal between student/client and staff done outside the institution shall not be handled at the office and the parties involved will be answerable.

Performance Appraisal and Promotions

Purpose

To ensure staff performance is regularly assessed, improved, and recognized, and that promotions are based on merit, competence, and institutional needs.

Objectives

- To evaluate employee performance against set targets.
- To identify strengths, weaknesses, and training needs.
- To provide a fair basis for rewards, promotions, and disciplinary action.
- To enhance accountability and productivity.

Appraisal System

- Conducted **annually**).
- Managed by the **Human Resource Department** in collaboration with Heads of Departments (HODs).
- Based on measurable indicators such as:
 - Teaching effectiveness.
 - Job output and quality.
 - Punctuality and attendance.
 - Innovation and ICT integration.
 - Teamwork and communication.
 - Adherence to institutional policies and ethics.

Appraisal Tools

- Standardized **Performance Appraisal Form** (rating scale 1–5).
- Self-assessment, supervisor evaluation, and peer review.
- Lesson observation, student feedback, exam results, and research contribution.
- Task completion, reliability, and service delivery.

Promotion Policy

Promotions are granted based on:

- Proven competence and sustained high performance.
- Required academic/professional qualifications.
- Relevant work experience.
- Availability of a vacancy or budgetary provision.
- Recommendation by the supervisor and HR.

All promotions must be approved by the **CEO/Manager**.

Documentation

Each staff member's appraisal report is filed in their personal record for reference in promotions, transfers, or training decisions.

Training and Professional Development

This is done to enhance staff skills, knowledge, and competence to meet evolving educational and technological demands.

Objectives

- To promote continuous learning and capacity building.
- To align staff skills with institutional objectives.
- To encourage adoption of emerging ICT tools and practices.
- To enhance teaching, management, and service quality.

Types of Training

- **Induction Training:** For newly recruited staff to understand institutional policies.
- **On-the-job Training:** Hands-on training in daily tasks or new systems.
- **Workshops and Seminars:** For new technologies, pedagogy, or ICT trends.
- **Formal Courses:** TVET, KNEC, or university courses for qualification upgrading.
- **E-learning:** Online short courses in ICT and management.

Sponsorship and Support

- The college may sponsor or co-fund staff attending relevant training.
- Sponsored staff must sign a **bond** to serve the college for a specified period after training.
- Staff may also pursue self-sponsored studies with prior approval to avoid disruption of duties.
- Ruralnet ICT also has plan to support students who are willing to study computer courses, but lack funds.
- Those who are willing to conduct front office training for employment purposes are also trained free provided they are alumni.

Evaluation

- HR evaluates the effectiveness of training programs through post-training reports and improved performance indicators.

Leave Policy, Remuneration, and Welfare

The main aim for this is to provide fair and consistent guidelines on leave entitlement, compensation, and staff welfare, in line with the **Kenya Employment Act** and institutional policies.

Leave Policy

Types of Leave:

1. **Sick Leave:**
 - Granted upon signs of unwell or unstable health.
 - Full pay for up to 30 days; half pay thereafter, subject to review.
2. **Maternity Leave:**
 - Female staff: 90 calendar days with full pay.
 - No loss of seniority or benefits.
3. **Paternity Leave:**
 - Male staff: 14 calendar days with full pay.
4. **Compassionate Leave:**
 - Up to 5 days for emergencies (death or illness of immediate family).
5. **Study Leave:**
 - Granted to staff pursuing approved studies, subject to service bond.
6. **Annual/Monthly leave:**
 - Should be granted monthly or yearly.

Remuneration Policy

- Salary scales are determined by:
 - Qualifications, job grade, and experience.
 - Institutional financial capability.
- Salaries are paid **monthly**.
- Regular **salary reviews** may occur every year or based on economic conditions.
- Additional allowances may include:
 - Responsibility allowance,
 - Transport allowance,
 - Extra service allowance
 - Congratulatory allowance

Staff Welfare

The college promotes staff well-being through:

- Health and safety programs.
- Hospital billing.
- Staff social welfare (for bereavement, weddings, etc.).
- Recreational and team-building activities.
- Counseling and mentorship services.

- Fair grievance and complaint handling procedures.

Disciplinary Procedures

Disciplinary procedures help maintain discipline, fairness, and order among all staff members while ensuring due process is observed.

Objectives

- To correct misconduct rather than punish.
- To protect the rights of both the institution and the employee.
- To uphold the integrity and reputation of the college.

Forms of Misconduct

- Absenteeism or habitual lateness.
- Insubordination or refusal to obey lawful orders.
- Negligence of duty.
- Misuse of institution's property.
- Theft, fraud, or corruption.
- Harassment or discrimination.
- Breach of confidentiality.
- Drunkenness or drug abuse during working hours.
- Academic malpractice

Disciplinary Procedure Steps

1. **Verbal Warning:**
 - For minor offenses; recorded in the employee's file.
2. **Written Warning:**
 - Issued if misconduct persists or is moderate.
3. **Show Cause Letter:**
 - Employee is asked to explain within a given timeframe.
4. **Disciplinary Hearing:**
 - Conducted by the **Disciplinary Committee** (HR, HOD, and CEO).
 - The employee may present witnesses or evidence.
5. **Decision:**
 - The committee recommends action:
 - Written warning,
 - Suspension,
 - Demotion,
 - Termination, or

- Dismissal (for gross misconduct).
- 6. **Appeal:**
 - The employee may appeal to the CEO within 14 days of decision.

Disciplinary Records

All proceedings, warnings, and decisions must be documented and kept in the employee's confidential file.

Code Reference

All disciplinary actions shall align with:

- Kenya Employment Act (2007, Revised 2021),
- Public Service Commission guidelines, and
- Institutional HR policy.

CHAPTER FOUR

ACADEMIC ADMINISTRATION POLICY

The **Academic Administration Policy** governs how all teaching, learning, and academic activities are conducted at Ruralnet ICT Academy. It ensures that the institution maintains **high academic standards, quality assurance, and compliance** with national education and training authorities.

Curriculum Design and Approval

This section outlines how an ICT college develops, reviews, and approves its academic programs to ensure **quality, relevance, and compliance** with national and international educational standards.

Purpose

The goal of curriculum design and approval is to ensure that all ICT-related courses offered by the college:

- Meet the **requirements of accrediting and regulatory bodies** such as **TVET-CDACC**, **KNEC**, or universities.
- Address **industry needs** and emerging technological trends.
- Equip students with **competent skills, knowledge**, and **professional ethics** relevant to ICT practice.

Curriculum Development Process

The process involves several key stages:

1. Needs Assessment:

- Conducted to identify skill gaps in the ICT sector and align courses with labor market demands.
- Involves consultation with employers, alumni, and professional bodies.

2. Curriculum Design:

- Curriculum developers (Trainers) prepare the structure, learning outcomes, course content, and assessment methods.
- Integrates both **theoretical and practical components** (e.g., coding, networking simulations, ICT resources).
- Emphasizes **competency-based education and training (CBET)** principles, especially for TVET/CDACC programs.

3. Internal Review:

- The draft curriculum is reviewed by the **Academic Board** or **Curriculum Committee** for quality assurance.
- Recommendations for improvement are made before submission for external evaluation.

4. Implementation:

- Once approved, the curriculum is rolled out, and teaching resources (equipment, labs, materials) are prepared.
- Lecturers are oriented on delivery and assessment methods.

5. Periodic Review:

- Conducted every 3–5 years or as directed by the regulatory body.
- Internal reviews are done monthly to ensure the curriculum remains **up-to-date** with technological advancements such as AI, cloud computing, data analytics, and IoT.

Teaching and Learning Methods (ICT Integration, Blended Learning)

This section outlines the approaches and strategies used by Ruralnet ICT to **deliver knowledge and skills effectively**. It emphasizes the use of **modern technology, interactive pedagogy, and student-centered methods** to enhance learning outcomes.

The goal is to ensure that teaching and learning processes:

- Produce **competent ICT and accounting professionals** capable of applying knowledge in real-world contexts.
- Incorporate **information and communication technology (ICT)** tools to make learning more engaging, flexible, and efficient.
- Encourage **innovation, collaboration, and continuous improvement** in both teaching practice and student learning.

ICT Integration in Teaching and Learning

ICT is embedded in all aspects of instruction to reflect the digital nature of the field. Key strategies include:

1. Use of Digital Learning Platforms

- Learning Management Systems (LMS) such as **Google Classroom, Moodle, or Microsoft Teams** are used to share notes, assignments, and feedback.
- Enables **online submission, grading, and performance tracking**.

2. Interactive Multimedia Tools

- Incorporates **videos, animations, virtual labs, simulations, and coding environments** (e.g., Visual Studio Code, Cisco Packet Tracer) to demonstrate concepts practically.
- Enhances understanding through visual and hands-on experiences.

3. E-Libraries and Online Resources

- Students access e-books, journals, and open educational resources for research and self-directed learning.
- Encourages **independent study** and critical thinking.

4. Virtual Collaboration Tools

- Platforms like **Zoom, Google Meet, and Slack** are used for virtual lectures, discussions, and group projects.
- Promotes communication beyond the classroom.

5. Digital Assessment and Feedback

- Online quizzes, coding tests, and digital project submissions help evaluate student understanding efficiently.
- Automated grading and instant feedback enhance learning outcomes.

Blended Learning Approach

Blended learning combines **face-to-face instruction** with **online education** to create a flexible, technology-enhanced learning environment.

1. Face-to-Face Component

- Conducted in classrooms, computer labs, or workshops.
- Focuses on demonstrations, hands-on practice, and real-time feedback.
- Encourages interaction between trainers and learners.

2. Online Component

- Delivered through e-learning platforms, recorded lectures, discussion forums, and virtual labs.
- Allows learners to study at their own pace and revisit materials.

3. Advantages of Blended Learning

- Promotes **flexibility** and accessibility.
- Encourages **self-regulated learning** and digital literacy.
- Supports **continuous learning** even beyond the physical classroom.
- Enables **data tracking** for academic performance improvement.

Student-Centered Learning Approaches

Student-centered learning (SCL) is an instructional approach that shifts the focus of education from the teacher to the student. It emphasizes **active participation, collaboration, critical thinking**, and **practical application** of knowledge — especially vital in ICT education where skills development and innovation are key.

The main goal of student-centered learning at Ruralnet ICT Academy is to:

- Develop **independent and critical thinkers** capable of solving real-world ICT problems.
- Encourage **active learning** through projects, labs, and collaborative work.
- Foster **creativity, innovation, and lifelong learning**.

- Align teaching with the **competency-based education (CBE)** model required by TVET/CDACC, KNEC, and universities.

Key Principles of Student-Centered Learning

1. **Active Learning:**
Students are directly engaged through coding, simulations, experiments, and interactive discussions rather than passive note-taking.
2. **Learner Autonomy:**
Students take responsibility for their own learning through self-directed projects, research, and peer collaboration.
3. **Competency-Based Education:**
Emphasis is placed on mastery of specific ICT skills and competencies rather than just completion of coursework.
4. **Collaborative Learning:**
Learners work in groups on tasks such as network configuration, database development, or web projects — simulating real workplace teamwork.
5. **Problem-Based Learning (PBL):**
Students solve authentic ICT challenges (e.g., troubleshooting network issues, designing applications, debugging programs, fixing software related issues emanating from Microsoft applications) that require creativity and analytical thinking.
6. **Experiential and Project-Based Learning:**
Learning is reinforced through **hands-on practice, attachments, hackathons, and capstone projects.**
7. **Continuous Feedback and Reflection:**
Trainers provide regular, formative feedback;

Students reflect on their learning process to identify strengths and improvement areas.
8. **ICT Integration:**
Use of e-learning platforms, simulations, coding environments, and multimedia tools to enhance learning and digital literacy.

Teaching Strategies for Student-Centered Learning at Ruralnet ICT academy

Method	Description	Example
Flipped Classroom	Students review theory or tutorials online, and class time is used for practice or discussion.	Going through HTML templates from ruralnet.co.ke before class, then coding a webpage during class.
Project-Based Learning (PBL)	Students work on long-term projects that integrate multiple skills.	Developing a school management system or mobile app as a group project.

Collaborative Learning	Peer-to-peer interaction to solve problems or discuss topics.	Group troubleshooting of network configurations.
Case Studies and Simulations	Real-world scenarios to apply ICT knowledge.	Simulating cybersecurity attacks and defense strategies.
Peer Teaching	Students explain or present topics to others.	A student demonstrates database normalization techniques to classmates.
Inquiry-Based Learning	Students research and investigate answers to open-ended questions.	"How can cloud computing improve business data storage?"
E-Learning and Blended Learning	Combines online materials with face-to-face interaction.	Using Moodle or Google Classroom for assignments and quizzes.

Role of Students

Students are expected to:

- Take **initiative** in their learning process.
- Participate actively in discussions, labs, and projects.
- Collaborate respectfully with peers.
- Demonstrate **critical thinking** and **problem-solving** in ICT tasks.
- Apply **ethical and responsible use of technology** in all coursework.

Assessment in Student-Centered Learning

- Assessments focus on **skills demonstration** and **practical application**, not memorization.
- Includes **continuous assessment**, **project evaluation**, **peer assessment**, and **self-assessment**.
- Rubrics are provided to ensure transparency and fairness.
- Formative feedback guides improvement before final evaluations.

Benefits of Student-Centered Learning in ICT

- Enhances **technical competence** and **employability**.
- Promotes **collaboration**, **communication**, and **leadership skills**.
- Encourages **innovation** and adaptability to emerging technologies.
- Improves **student motivation and retention** through engagement.
- Builds a **lifelong learning mindset**, essential in the dynamic ICT industry.

Institutional Support for Student-Centered Learning

To effectively implement SCL, Ruralnet ICT must:

- Provide **modern labs, internet access, and e-learning platforms**.
- Train staff in **active learning methodologies and ICT integration**.
- Develop **policies** encouraging innovation, research, and student participation.
- Recognize and reward excellence in teaching and student innovation.

Examination Administration and Grading System

This section provides guidelines for the **planning, conducting, and evaluating of student assessments**. It ensures that examinations and grading are **fair, transparent, reliable, and aligned** with the standards set by regulatory bodies such as **TVET-CDACC, KNEC, or universities**.

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Maintain **academic integrity** and **quality assurance** in assessment processes.
- Ensure that student evaluations reflect **competence, knowledge, and practical skills** gained.
- Provide clear and consistent criteria for measuring academic performance.
- Comply with national and institutional examination regulations.

Examination Administration Procedures

Examination administration covers the entire process from setting to release of results.

a. Examination Planning

- The **Academic Board or Examinations Committee/HOD** prepares the academic calendar and examination timetable.
- Trainers submit exam questions early for moderation and approval.
- Students are informed of exam schedules and rules in advance.

b. Setting and Moderation of Examinations

- Examinations are designed to assess both **theoretical knowledge** and **practical ICT skills**.
- Question papers and marking schemes are **moderated internally** and, where applicable, **externally**.
- This ensures that exams meet **standard learning outcomes** and **curriculum objectives**.

c. Examination Conduct

- Exams are conducted under strict **supervision and invigilation** to prevent malpractice.
- Students must present valid identification and adhere to examination rules.
- Electronic devices, unauthorized notes, and plagiarism are prohibited.
- Examination irregularities lead to **disciplinary action** as per institutional policy.

d. Marking and Verification

- Scripts are marked promptly by course trainers using approved marking guides.
- Marks are verified by the **Head of Department (HOD)** and the **Examination Officer** to ensure consistency and accuracy.

e. Results Approval and Release

- Results are presented to the **Academic Board** for approval before publication.
- Students can access results through announcement page in our website, student portals, or printed transcripts.
- Confidentiality and data protection are maintained at all stages.

Grading System

Grading systems generally follows standardized score ranges:

Marks Range (%)	Grade	Description	Remarks
80 – 100	A. Mastery	Excellent	Distinction
70 – 79	Mastery	Very Good	Credit
60 – 69	Proficiency	Good	Credit
50 – 59	Competent	Fair	Pass
Below 50	Not Competent	Poor/Fail	Fail

- **Continuous Assessments (CATs):** 100%
(This may vary slightly depending on the decision of the trainer.)

Supplementary and Special Examinations

- Students who fail a paper may be allowed to **sit a supplementary exam**, and he/she is expected to pay a re-sit fee of Kshs. 500
- **Special exams** are provided for students who miss exams due to valid reasons (illness, bereavement, official duty), upon approval.
- Re-sit marks are usually **capped at the pass grade**.

Examination Security and Confidentiality

- Examination materials are **secured** in locked storage before use.
- Printing, transport, and distribution are handled by **authorized personnel only**.
- Examination data and results are stored securely and backed up electronically.
- Any leakage, alteration, or unauthorized access constitutes a serious disciplinary offense.

External Examinations

- For programs under **KASNEB, TVET-CDACC** or **KNEC**, the institution follows their rules for registration, administration, and grading.
- The institution acts as an **approved examination center** and collaborates with external moderators and assessors.

Continuous Improvement

- Ruralnet periodically reviews her examination and grading systems to maintain **fairness, accuracy, and relevance**.
- Feedback from students, trainers, and examiners is used to enhance assessment quality.

Student Assessment and Moderation

This section outlines how students' academic performance is **evaluated, verified, and standardized** to ensure fairness, consistency, and alignment with national and institutional standards. It focuses on **how assessments are conducted and moderated** to maintain the integrity and quality of education in ICT programs.

The purpose of student assessment and moderation is to:

- Evaluate **student learning outcomes** and competencies effectively.
- Ensure **consistency and fairness** across different courses, trainers, and assessment methods.
- Align all assessment practices with **ASNEB, KCDACC, KNEC, or university guidelines**.
- Maintain **academic credibility and transparency** in the evaluation process.

Types of Student Assessment

Assessment at Ruralnet is continuous and multi-dimensional. It combines both **formative (ongoing)** and **summative (final)** assessments.

a. Continuous Assessment (Formative)

- Conducted throughout the course duration to monitor student progress.
- Includes **class tests, assignments, group projects, practical exercises, quizzes, and presentations**.
- Encourages students to improve learning through regular feedback.

b. Final Examination (Summative)

- Conducted at the end of the learning period to evaluate cumulative knowledge and skills.
- Includes PowerPoint practical assessment that contains six slides;
 - The first slide contains the title ‘MY EXPERIENCE AT RURALNET ICT ACADEMY’ and subtitle containing student’s name,
 - Slide two contains list of contents learnt while at ruralnet
 - Slide three contains what pleased the student while pursuing his/her course
 - Slide four contains what the student expected to learn but they didn’t get the concept, and the ones covered but not well understood.
 - Slide five contains challenges faced while studying at Ruralnet ICT Academy
 - Slide six contains recommendations on the above challenges for improvement.
 - The last slide contains designed pictures of what they learnt
- The presentation is then styled
- Finally, it is sent to Ruralnet’s official email; (ruralnet2016@gmail.com)

c. KASNEB and Competency-Based Assessment (CBA) – For TVET/CDACC

- Based on **demonstration of specific competencies** or skills.
- Students must show mastery in performing given accounting and ICT tasks or projects.
- Uses **observation checklists, portfolios, and performance evidence.**

Assessment Principles

All assessments must follow these guiding principles:

- **Validity:** Tests what it is intended to test (e.g., programming skills through coding tasks).
- **Reliability:** Produces consistent results across assessors and settings.
- **Fairness:** Free from bias and accessible to all learners.
- **Transparency:** Students are informed about assessment criteria and grading systems in advance.
- **Accountability:** Trainers maintain proper records of student marks and feedback.

Moderation of Assessments

Moderation ensures that assessments and results are consistent, objective, and meet institutional and national standards. It is carried out at different levels.

a. Internal Moderation

- Conducted within the college by experienced trainers or Heads of Department (HODs).
- Involves reviewing:

- Examination questions and marking schemes before exams.
 - Sample marked scripts and projects after grading.
- Ensures uniformity in marking and fairness in grading among different trainers.
 - Addresses any discrepancies before results are finalized.

b. External Moderation

- Conducted by **external moderators** appointed by **KASNEB and VET-CDACC, KNEC, or university partners**.
- Verifies that internal assessments meet required national and professional standards.
- Confirms fairness and accuracy of student marks and reports.
- Provides recommendations for improvement in future assessments.

Feedback and Continuous Improvement

- Students receive **timely and constructive feedback** to help them identify strengths and areas for improvement.
- Trainers use assessment outcomes to **adjust teaching methods** and address learning gaps.
- The institution periodically reviews its assessment tools and processes based on moderation reports and performance trends.

Assessment Records Management

- All student assessment records (marks, scripts, practical reports, portfolios) are securely stored and backed up.
- Access to these records is restricted to authorized academic staff.
- Records are retained for a period of 5 months from the time of course completion for audit and verification purposes.

Special Considerations

- Students with valid reasons (e.g., illness, disability, bereavement) are allowed **special assessments or extensions**, upon approval by the CEO
- Any cases of **academic dishonesty** (cheating, plagiarism, collusion) are handled under the institution's **Academic Integrity Policy** and attract disciplinary action.

Research and Innovation Policy

This section outlines the framework through which the ICT college promotes, manages, and supports **research, innovation, and creative problem-solving** among staff and students. It

ensures that all research and innovation activities contribute to **technological advancement, academic excellence, and community development**.

The Research and Innovation Policy aims to:

- Promote a **culture of inquiry, creativity, and technological innovation** within the college.
- Encourage **evidence-based research** that addresses real-world ICT and socio-economic challenges.
- Strengthen **industry-academia collaboration** to enhance applied research and innovation.
- Guide ethical research conduct and protect intellectual property rights.

Objectives

- To support **staff and student participation** in research and innovation activities.
- To establish a structured process for **proposal development, funding, implementation, and dissemination**.
- To ensure that research aligns with **national priorities**, institutional goals, and **TVET/CDACC or university standards**.
- To promote the development of **ICT-based solutions** for community and industry needs.
- To recognize and reward **innovative ideas, prototypes, and publications**.

Scope

This policy applies to:

- All **academic and technical staff** conducting research or supervising projects.
- All **students** undertaking final-year or competency-based innovation projects.
- **Collaborative projects** involving external partners, industries, or funding agencies.
- Institutional **research centers, innovation hubs, and incubators** established for technology development.

Research Focus Areas

Ruralnet ICT prioritizes research and innovation in emerging ICT and related fields such as:

- Software development and systems engineering.
- Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Data Science.
- Cybersecurity and ethical hacking.

- Computer networking and cloud computing.
- Internet of Things (IoT) and embedded systems.
- Digital literacy, e-learning technologies, and ICT for development.
- Green computing and sustainable ICT practices.
- Finance and accounting advancements
- Managerial Accounting
- Auditing and Assurance
- Taxation
- Accounting Information System (AIS)
- Corporate governance and ethics

Research and Innovation Structure

To manage research activities effectively, Ruralnet establishes:

- **A Research and Innovation Committee (RIC) or Directorate**, responsible for:
 - Approving research proposals.
 - Overseeing project implementation and reporting.
 - Managing research ethics compliance.
- **Departmental Research Coordinators**, who:
 - Guide students and staff on proposal writing.
 - Coordinate departmental innovation projects.
- **Innovation Hubs or Labs**, where students can prototype and test their ICT solutions.

Funding and Resource Support

- Ruralnet allocates an **annual research and innovation budget**.
- Partnerships with industries provide **mentorship, equipment, and internship opportunities**.
- Access to **digital libraries, ICT infrastructure, and laboratories** supports research activities.
- For accounting courses;

Funding Type	Source Examples	Usage
Institutional Funding	Ruralnet budgets, academic councils	Faculty salaries, course materials
Government Grants	Education ministries, research councils	Curriculum dev., research, public accounting

Industry & Professional	ACCA, CPA firms, corporate sponsors	Guest speakers, internships, sponsorships
International Donors	World Bank, IMF, OECD, UNDP	Public sector/governance accounting
Philanthropy	Alumni, foundations	Scholarships, professorships, tech labs
Student-Focused Resources	Scholarships, exam prep, digital tools	Tuition help, academic success

Research Ethics and Integrity

All research must adhere to high ethical standards, including:

- **Honesty and transparency** in data collection, analysis, and reporting.
- **Respect for intellectual property rights** and proper acknowledgment of sources.
- **Informed consent** and confidentiality in research involving human participants.
- **Prohibition of plagiarism, data falsification, or fabrication.**
- Compliance with institutional and national research ethics guidelines.

Research Dissemination

- Research outcomes are shared through **seminars, conferences, journals, and online platforms.**
- The institution may publish a **college research journal or newsletter.**
- Staff and students are encouraged to present papers at **local and international conferences.**
- Partnerships with other academic and professional institutions promote **knowledge exchange.**

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Recognition

- The Research and Innovation Committee regularly evaluates research outputs and impact.
- Successful projects are recognized through **awards, certificates, or promotions.**
- Findings from research are used to **improve curriculum, teaching methods, and institutional development.**

Link with Academic Programs

- Research is integrated into teaching and learning, particularly through **capstone assignments, and competency-based assessments.**

- Students are guided by qualified supervisors to ensure **methodological rigor and originality**.
- Research findings are used to **update course content** and maintain curriculum relevance.

Academic Integrity (Anti-Plagiarism, Ethical ICT Use)

This section establishes the standards of **honesty, responsibility, and ethical behavior** expected of all students and staff in academic and research activities. It ensures that all work submitted or performed represents **original effort** and upholds the **values of professionalism and integrity** at Ruralnet ICT Academy.

The purpose of the Academic Integrity Policy is to:

- Promote **honest scholarship** and **ethical academic conduct**.
- Prevent and address **academic dishonesty, plagiarism, and misuse of ICT resources**.
- Foster a culture of **trust, accountability, and professionalism** within Ruralnet
- Ensure compliance with **institutional regulations** and **national academic standards**.

Principles of Academic Integrity

All members of the college community—students, lecturers, and researchers—are expected to:

- Produce and present **original work**.
- **Acknowledge** all sources of information, data, and ideas appropriately.
- Use **ICT tools and resources responsibly**.
- Avoid any behavior that undermines **fairness, honesty, and academic standards**.
- Respect **intellectual property rights** and confidentiality in academic work.

Forms of Academic Misconduct

Academic misconduct includes;

a. Plagiarism

- Presenting another person's ideas, words, or digital content as one's own without proper citation.
- Copying from websites, journals, reports, or classmates without acknowledgment.
- Submitting work generated by AI or software without disclosure or permission.

b. Cheating in Examinations or Tests

- Possessing unauthorized materials during exams.

- Communicating with others or using devices (phones, smartwatches) to gain unfair advantage.
- Impersonating another candidate or colluding in exam irregularities.

c. Fabrication or Falsification

- Making up data, results, or citations in projects or reports.
- Altering marks, attendance, or academic records.

d. Unauthorized Collaboration

- Working with others on assignments meant to be done individually.
- Sharing confidential exam questions or solutions.

e. Misuse of ICT Resources

- Using institutional computers or networks for unethical or illegal activities such as hacking, piracy, or spreading malware.
- Accessing or sharing restricted data without authorization.
- Installing unauthorized software or bypassing security systems.

Anti-Plagiarism Measures

- All academic work (assignments, research projects, reports, and theses) must be **checked using plagiarism detection tools** such as Turnitin, Grammarly, or institutional software.
- Acceptable **similarity index**:
 - **Below 20%** for student work (unless otherwise specified).
- Trainers must educate students on **proper citation and referencing techniques** (American Psychological Association, Modern Language Association, or Harvard style).

Ethical Use of ICT Resources

Ruralnet provides ICT resources (computers, internet, software, and e-learning platforms) for **academic and professional development**. Users must:

- Access only authorized systems and data.
- Avoid downloading and watching/listening to videos and music
- Avoid downloading or sharing pirated software.
- Use institutional email and online platforms for **official and educational purposes**.
- Maintain **cybersecurity awareness**, including safeguarding passwords and personal data.
- Report any **security breaches or unethical digital behavior** to the ICT department.

Academic Integrity Training and Awareness

- All new students and staff undergo **orientation on academic ethics and ICT responsibility**.
- Regular **seminars and workshops** are held to promote awareness of plagiarism, intellectual property rights, and digital ethics.
- The institution provides guides and resources on **ethical research writing and ICT usage**.

Disciplinary Actions for Academic Misconduct

Violations of academic integrity are treated seriously and may lead to disciplinary measures such as:

- **Written warning or deduction of marks** for minor offenses.
- **Cancellation of an exam or project** in cases of confirmed cheating or plagiarism.
- **Suspension or expulsion** for repeated or severe violations.
- **Withdrawal of certificates or transcripts** if misconduct is discovered after completion of studies.

Continuous Improvement

- The institution reviews its academic integrity and ICT ethics policies yearly.
- Feedback from staff, students, and regulators helps refine the policy to match **emerging technologies** (AI tools, cloud computing, cybersecurity challenges).
- Promotes a **culture of responsibility, innovation, and ethical professionalism** among graduates.

CHAPTER FIVE

STUDENT AFFAIRS POLICY

The **Student Affairs Policy** provides guidelines for managing all **non-academic aspects** of student life at Ruralnet ICT Academy

It ensures that students learn in a **safe, supportive, and inclusive environment** that promotes personal growth, discipline, leadership, and innovation alongside academic achievement.

Objectives of the Policy

The main objectives of the Student Affairs Policy are to:

1. Promote the **welfare, safety, and holistic development** of students.
2. Ensure **effective student representation and participation** in institutional governance.
3. Maintain **discipline, integrity, and ethical conduct** among students.
4. Provide **support services** that enhance learning, career growth, and personal wellbeing.
5. Encourage **co-curricular and extra-curricular engagement** to build soft skills and leadership capacity.
6. Foster a **culture of innovation, responsibility, and citizenship** in line with ICT professionalism.

Admission and Registration Procedures

The **Admission and Registration Procedures** outline the guidelines for admitting and enrolling students into various ICT programs.

They ensure that the process is **transparent, merit-based, and compliant** with the standards set by relevant regulatory bodies such as **TVET/CDACC, KASNEB, KNEC**, and the **Ministry of Education**.

This policy guarantees fairness, equal opportunity, and accountability in admitting students to certificate, diploma, and higher diploma programs.

The objectives of the admission and registration policy are to:

1. Maintain **standardized procedures** for admitting qualified applicants.
2. Ensure that **entry requirements** meet accreditation and national education standards.
3. Promote **transparency and fairness** in student selection.
4. Ensure **accurate data management** of student records.
5. Support students through a **smooth transition** from admission to academic registration.

Admission Policy

Admission Principles

- Admission is based on **academic merit, eligibility, and availability of space** in the chosen program.
- The institution upholds the principles of **equity, inclusivity, and non-discrimination** regardless of gender, religion, or background.
- All applicants must meet the **minimum entry requirements** approved by **TVET/CDACC or KNEC**.
- The college reserves the right to **verify academic documents** and reject falsified credentials.

Entry Requirements for computer Courses

Entry requirements vary depending on the program level and regulatory body.

Level / Course Type	What it is	Usual Minimum Requirements
Short / Certificate courses (e.g. basic ICT skills, computer applications)	Very introductory skills: ➤ Introduction, ➤ Microsoft Office, ➤ Basic hardware/software, ➤ Internet, ➤ Software installation.	Basic pass in KCSE and above.
ICT Technician / Craft Certificate Level 5	➤ Apply Basic Electronics ➤ Develop Computer Program ➤ Install Computer Software ➤ Manage Database Systems ➤ Manage Operating System ➤ Perform Computer Repair and Maintenance	KCSE minimum grade D plain Certified Level 4 artisan certificate (ICT Level 4) or previous ICT certificate plus some experience.
Diploma in ICT / ICT Technician Diploma	➤ Apply Basic Electronics ➤ Control ICT Security Threats ➤ Develop Computer Program ➤ Install Computer Software ➤ Manage Database Systems ➤ Manage Information System ➤ Mobile Application Development ➤ Perform Computer Networking ➤ Perform Computer Repair and Maintenance ➤ Perform Graphic Design ➤ Perform ICT System Support ➤ Perform System Analysis and Design ➤ Perform Website Design	KCSE with at least C- (C Minus) Craft certificate or equivalent ICT-level certificate (Level 5) from recognized institutions.

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Entry Requirements for KASNEB/Accounting Courses

Course	Full Name / Abbreviation	Typical Minimum Entry Requirements
CAMS (Certificate in Accounting & Management Skills)	CAMS	➤ Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) grade D & Above .
ATD (Accounting Technicians Diploma)	ATD	➤ KCSE with a mean grade of C-- (C Minus) or equivalent. ➤ OR a certificate such as Accounting & Management Skills (CAMS) or other technician/diploma certificate recognized by KASNEB.
CPA (Certified Public Accountant)	CPA	➤ KCSE with an aggregate average of at least C+. ➤ KACE (Kenya Advanced Certificate of Education) with at least two Principal passes, with good scores in Mathematics and English at KCE or equivalent. ➤ A diploma or professional examination certificate (technician or equivalent) from KASNEB or recognized institution. ➤ A degree from a recognized university. ➤ IGCSE grade C in 6 papers with C in both English & Mathematics.
CIFA (Certified Investment & Financial Analysts)	CIFA	➤ KCSE mean grade C+ or equivalent. ➤ Also accepts a professional qualification (e.g. another KASNEB professional certificate or diploma) or a degree from a recognized university.
Computerized Accounting	(Short course or Certificate in Computerised Accounting)	➤ Basic pass in KCSE, ➤ Basic mathematics and some computer skills.

Admission Procedure

The admission process generally follows these steps:

Step 1: Application

- Prospective students obtain an **application form** (from RuralNet portal or for those making physical inquiries, their details are captured by the recruiting officer or staff).
- Applicants fill in their details, attach certified academic certificates, ID copies, and passport-size photographs.
- A **non-refundable application fee** (included in the fees as per the course) must be paid.

Step 2: Verification of Documents

- The admissions office verifies all academic and identification documents.
- Applications that meet the requirements are forwarded to the **Academic Board** for approval.
- Fraudulent or incomplete applications are rejected.

Step 3: Selection and Admission

- Successful applicants receive an **official admission letter** specifying:
 - Course admitted to
 - Reporting date
 - Duration of study
 - Fees structure and payment schedule
 - Required materials (e.g., laptop, uniform, or tools)
- Admission may be offered on a **first-come, first-served basis** where space is limited.

Step 4: Orientation

- Newly admitted students undergo an **orientation program** to familiarize them with:
 - Academy rules and regulations
 - Academic structure and examination policies
 - ICT facilities, e-learning platforms, and student services
 - Code of conduct, health, and safety policies

Registration Procedure

Once admitted, students must complete formal registration to become active members of the institution.

a. Requirements for Registration

- Valid **admission letter**.
- Proof of **fee payment or installment plan**.
- **Certified copies** of academic certificates and identification documents.

- **Two passport-size photographs.**
- Signed copies of the **student declaration form, code of conduct, and ICT usage policy.**

b. Registration Steps

1. Report to the **Admissions Office** with the required documents.
2. Verify personal and course details in the Management Information System (MIS)
3. Receive **student admission number and ID card.**
4. Register online or manually for the semester units or modules.
5. Receive access credentials to **e-learning systems and ICT labs.**

Record Management

- The Admissions Office maintains **confidential student records** — personal data, academic history, and registration details.
- Student information is stored in a secure **Management Information System (MIS).**
- Access to data is restricted to authorized staff in compliance with data protection laws.

Withdrawal or Discontinuation

- A student wishing to withdraw must submit a **written notification** to the instructor.
- Ruralnet may discontinue a student due to:
 - Academic failure
 - Misconduct
 - Non-payment of fees
 - Absenteeism beyond allowable limits (One week)

Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules

The **Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules** establish the expected standards of behavior, ethics, and responsibility among students within Ruralnet. It ensures a safe, respectful, and conducive environment for learning, innovation, and personal growth. Its main purpose is;

- To promote discipline, integrity, and accountability among students.
- To maintain harmony and respect among students, staff, and the institution.
- To safeguard the institution's reputation and uphold its core values.
- To guide corrective measures when rules or ethical standards are violated.

General Conduct Expectations

All students must:

- Adhere to all **institutional rules and regulations**.
- Show **respect** to trainers, staff, and fellow students.
- Uphold **honesty, fairness, and responsibility** in all academic and social activities.
- Observe **punctuality and regular attendance** in classes, examinations, and official events.
- Take good care of **college property, ICT equipment, and facilities**.
- Dress **appropriately and decently** within the learning environment to avoid distractions during learning process.
- Comply with **ICT usage policies**, including responsible internet and device use.

Academic Integrity and conduct

- **Plagiarism, cheating, and impersonation** during exams or assignments are strictly prohibited.
- Students must properly acknowledge all **sources, software, and projects** used in academic work.
- **Collusion** (unauthorized cooperation) is treated as a serious academic offense.
- Breaches of academic integrity may lead to disciplinary action, including suspension or expulsion.
- Use computers, internet access, and digital platforms **only for educational purposes**.
- Avoid **cyberbullying, hacking, or misuse of digital resources**.
- Respect **data privacy, intellectual property, and cybersecurity ethics**.
- Not install, modify, or delete institutional software without permission.
- Report any system abuse or security breach immediately to ICT administration.

Social and Behavioral Conduct

Students shall:

- Refrain from **fighting, harassment, discrimination, or intimidation** of any kind.
- Avoid **drug and alcohol abuse**, smoking, or illegal activities within campus premises.
- Maintain **peaceful coexistence** and resolve conflicts through dialogue or official channels.
- Respect **gender equality and diversity**.
- Abstain from political activities or demonstrations that disrupt academic operations.

Attendance and Punctuality

- Regular attendance is mandatory for all academic sessions and examinations.
- Absence without valid reason or permission may lead to disciplinary warning or exclusion.
- Students must sign class attendance registers and be punctual for lessons and ICT sessions.

Disciplinary Procedures

When a student violates the code of conduct:

1. **Reporting:** The case is reported to the Trainer who carries the matter to the admin.
2. **Investigation:** Admin investigates the issue fairly and confidentially.
3. **Hearing:** The student is given a chance to explain or defend themselves.
4. **Verdict and Sanction:** Depending on the severity, penalties includes:
 - Verbal or written warning
 - Suspension
 - Restitution (paying for damage or loss)
 - Dismissal or expulsion

Appeals Process

- A student dissatisfied with a disciplinary decision may **appeal in writing** to the Academic head within 3 days.
- The appeal must provide **valid reasons or new evidence** for reconsideration.

Recognition and Positive Conduct

- Students who consistently demonstrate **exemplary behavior, leadership, and discipline** receives commendations or awards.
- Ruralnet ICT also grant **leadership positions** or **certificates of good conduct** to such students.

Student Welfare Policy (Counseling, Health, and Accommodation)

The Student Welfare Policy ensures that all learners enjoy a **safe, supportive, and healthy environment** that promotes **academic success, emotional stability, and personal growth**.

It recognizes that students' well-being is essential for effective learning and holistic development. Its main aim is;

- To provide **psychological and emotional support** through counseling services.
- To promote **physical health, safety, and wellness** on campus.
- To ensure **adequate, affordable, and secure accommodation** for students.
- To foster a **student-centered environment** that encourages productivity, discipline, and self-care.
- To enhance **retention and success** by addressing non-academic challenges.

A. Counseling Services

This is done by the institution manager who may sometimes invites other professionals to offer various counseling services. CEO/Manager oversees such activities and monitors outcomes.

- **Academic Counseling:** Guidance on study habits, time management, exam anxiety, and career choices.
- **Personal Counseling:** Support for emotional, family, or relationship issues.
- **Career Guidance:** Mentorship and advice on ICT-related career paths, internships, and job preparation.
- **Crisis Intervention:** Immediate assistance for students facing trauma, depression, or other emergencies.

CHAPTER SIX:

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE AND RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

The **Infrastructure and Resource Management Policy** ensures that the institution's **physical, technological, and learning resources** are properly planned, developed, maintained, and utilized to support **quality education, innovation, and operational efficiency**.

It focuses on creating a **safe, modern, and ICT-enabled environment** conducive to teaching, learning, and research.

Objectives

- To establish **effective management** and **optimal utilization** of all institutional resources.

- To ensure **adequate and up-to-date ICT infrastructure** to meet academic and administrative needs.
- To maintain **safety, sustainability, and accessibility** in all college facilities.
- To promote **asset accountability** and transparency in resource allocation.
- To continuously **upgrade facilities** in line with technological advancement and educational standards.

Management of Computer Labs and Equipment Policy

This section ensures **efficient, secure, and sustainable use** of computer laboratories and ICT equipment within Ruralnet ICT Academy.

It provides clear guidelines for **maintenance, access control, usage ethics, and resource accountability** to support teaching, learning, and research.

Computer Lab Administration

- **ICT Officer** is responsible for daily operations, maintenance, and supervision.
- The **Head of ICT Department** oversees all labs and ensures compliance with institutional ICT policies.
- A **lab usage timetable** must be available always to coordinate class schedules, free access hours, and special sessions.
- Only **authorized students, trainers, and staff** may use the labs.
- For now, entry requires manual attendance register, but with time, an entry system for student will be developed.
- Access outside official hours is not allowed unless authorized by ICT officer.
- Visitors or external users must obtain clearance from administration.

Usage Guidelines

- Labs must be used **strictly for academic and research purposes** — not for gaming, social media, or personal entertainment.
- Users must **sign in and sign out** in the attendance register or system.
- Eating, drinking, or smoking in labs is **strictly prohibited**.
- Students must **maintain cleanliness** and orderliness at their workstations.
- All users must **log off and shut down computers properly** after use.
- Only **authorized software** installed by the ICT department must be used.
- Installation, modification, or deletion of programs is **prohibited** unless approved by the ICT officer.
- Users must **not alter system configurations** or attempt to bypass security measures.
- Personal devices (USB drives, external disks) must be **scanned for viruses** before connection; only from ICT officer.
- Internet access is primarily for **research, learning, and institutional communication**.

- **Cyberbullying, hacking, or downloading illegal content** is strictly prohibited.
- Users must comply with the institution's **Cybersecurity and Acceptable Use Policy**.
- Bandwidth-heavy activities are restricted to ensure fair use.

Maintenance and Technical Support

Preventive Maintenance

- Regular **inspection, cleaning, and updating** of hardware and software must be done on a monthly basis.
- Antivirus programs and system updates should be kept current.
- Faulty equipment should be reported immediately to the **Lab Technician** and recorded in the **maintenance logbook**.

Repairs and Replacements

- Minor faults are handled internally by the ICT team.
- Major repairs or replacements require **administrative approval and documentation**.
- Obsolete or irreparable equipment is **decommissioned responsibly** following e-waste guidelines.

Inventory and Asset Management

- Each item (computer, monitor, router, projector, etc.) must have a **unique asset tag**.
- The ICT Department maintains an **inventory register** indicating serial numbers, purchase date, and current condition.
- Annual **physical verification and audits** ensure accountability and prevent loss.

Safety and Security Measures

Physical Security

- Labs must be **locked and alarmed** when not in use.
- All laptop and computer equipment must be kept back in their respective places after use.
- **CCTV cameras** may be installed for surveillance and asset protection.
- Only authorized personnel may access **network servers, storage rooms, and power panels**.

Health and Safety

- Proper **ventilation and lighting** must be maintained.
- **Ergonomic furniture** should be used to reduce strain during long computer sessions.

- **Fire extinguishers** and **emergency exits** must be clearly marked and functional.
- Students must be trained on **basic lab safety and emergency procedures**.

Training and Support

- Students receive **orientation** on lab rules, ICT ethics, and data security at the start of each term.
- Lab technicians and trainers undergo **continuous ICT training** to stay updated with emerging technologies.
- Ruralnet ICT promotes **ICT literacy programs** for both staff and students.

Monitoring and Evaluation

- Lab usage and performance shall be **monitored through** manual reports.
- Feedback is collected from users to identify **areas for improvement**.
- Periodic evaluations guide decisions on **upgrades, budgeting, and resource expansion**.

Software Licensing and Maintenance Policy

The **Software Licensing and Maintenance Policy** ensures that all software used within the Ruralnet is **legal, secure, properly maintained, and up-to-date**.

It aims to promote **compliance with intellectual property laws**, prevent cybersecurity risks, and support the institution's **academic and administrative efficiency**. The main aim is;

- To ensure that all software is **genuinely acquired and properly licensed**.
- To define procedures for **installation, maintenance, and updates** of institutional software.
- To protect the institution from **legal, financial, and security risks** related to unlicensed software.
- To promote the use of **open-source and educational software** where appropriate.
- To maintain **system reliability and user productivity** through regular updates and support.

Software Acquisition and Licensing

- All software acquisitions must go through the **ICT Department** and follow institutional procurement procedures.
- Software must be purchased only from **authorized vendors or developers**.

- Each software must have **valid license documentation**, including:
 - License certificate or key
 - Proof of purchase (invoice or receipt)
 - Version and expiry details
- The ICT Officer maintains a **Software License Register** containing all this information.
- **No software shall be acquired through illegal means; by hacking, cracking or unauthorized software piracy.**

Types of Software Licensing

Type	Description
Proprietary Software	Commercial software with paid licenses (e.g., Microsoft Office, Adobe, AutoCAD, QuickBooks, printer keys, Photoshop).
Open-Source Software	Free software that can be used and customized under open licenses (e.g., SQL, win11, Xamp, Visual studio, Web browsers, 360TS, LibreOffice).
Educational Licenses	Academic or discounted versions for institutions (e.g., Microsoft Academic, Autodesk Education).
Subscription-Based	Software paid for on a renewable monthly or yearly basis (e.g., Office 365, cloud tools, Namecheap domain, Quickbooks).

- Software installation without proper authorization or license is **strictly prohibited**.
- Periodic **software audits** shall be conducted to verify compliance annually.
- Expired or unused licenses must be **renewed, transferred, or deactivated** as appropriate.
- Copying, sharing, or distributing licensed software without permission is a **disciplinary and legal offense**.

Software Installation and Configuration

- Only **ICT officer** should install or configure software.
- Each installation must follow the **standardized setup checklist** to ensure compatibility and security.
- Personal software installations by students on institutional devices are **not allowed** unless approved.
- Any installation on lab computers must maintain **uniform configurations** for easier management and troubleshooting.
- The ICT Department shall keep **records of installed versions** and ensure compatibility with operating systems and hardware.
- Outdated or unsupported software must be **phased out** systematically to avoid security vulnerabilities.

Software Maintenance and Updates

Regular Updates

All institutional computers must have **weekly updates** for:

- Operating systems
- Security patches
- Applications and utilities

Technical Support

- The ICT Department provides **routine maintenance and troubleshooting** for all software-related issues.
- Maintenance logs must record:
 - Software problems encountered
 - Actions taken
 - Date and person responsible
 - Funds incurred
- Vendors or developers may be contacted for **specialized support** when under warranty or service contract.

Backup and Data Protection

- Critical systems (e.g., databases, ERP, LMS) contain **backups** stored securely on servers laptop (No. 12 [Source File]) and RuralNet drive account.
- Backups must be tested periodically to ensure recoverability.
- Security software (antivirus, firewall) must be **weekly updated** to protect against threats.

Open Source and Institutional Software Policy

- The institution encourages the use of **open-source software** for educational and cost-saving purposes where feasible.
- Custom institutional software (MIS, e-learning platform, and accounts available on the website) shall be:
 - Properly documented
 - Maintained by an ICT officer
 - Regularly reviewed for performance and security

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
ICT Officer	Approve installations, maintain software inventory, ensure compliance, and manage updates.
Users (Staff/Students)	Use software responsibly, report issues, and avoid tampering or piracy.
College Administration	Provide budget allocation for software renewal and upgrades. Verify vendor authenticity and ensure proper license documentation during purchase.

Monitoring and Compliance

- The ICT Department conducts **annual software audits** to verify compliance.
- Any unauthorized or pirated software discovered will be **immediately uninstalled** and reported. The individual involved will be charged to pay a fee of Kshs. 2,000

Disposal: Safe Decommissioning of Obsolete ICT Assets

This policy outlines how Ruralnet responsibly disposes of outdated, damaged, or obsolete ICT equipment and materials. The goal is to ensure **data security, environmental sustainability, and compliance with legal and Ruralnet regulations**.

Identification of Obsolete ICT Assets

- ICT equipment such as **computers, servers, printers, routers, and storage devices** are monthly assessed to determine usability and efficiency.
- Assets are classified as obsolete when they:
 - No longer meet operational or academic requirements.
 - Are beyond economical repair.
 - Are incompatible with current systems or software.
 - Pose maintenance or security challenges.
- The ICT department prepares an **asset decommissioning report** listing items recommended for disposal, approved by management.

Data Security and Sanitization

- Before disposal, all storage media (hard drives, SSDs, USBs, etc.) are **securely wiped, degaussed, or physically destroyed** to prevent data recovery.
- Sensitive institutional or student data is handled in accordance with the **Data Protection Act (Kenya, 2019){Attached at the end of this policy}**. Certified data destruction tools and methods are used, and a **data destruction certificate** is maintained for accountability.

Environmental Considerations (E-Waste Management)

- Disposal processes comply with **National Environment Management Authority (NEMA)** guidelines and **e-waste management regulations**.
- Reusable components are salvaged and repurposed where possible.
- Non-repairable equipment is handed over to **licensed e-waste recyclers or collection centers**.
- The college promotes environmentally responsible practices to reduce electronic waste and pollution.

Disposal Authorization and Documentation

- Disposal is carried out only after **formal approval** from the institution's management or board.
- A disposal committee oversees the process to ensure transparency and accountability.
- Detailed records are kept, including:
 - Asset identification details (model, serial number).
 - Disposal method (reuse, recycle, destruction).
 - Date and responsible officer.
- A **disposal certificate** is issued and filed for auditing and compliance purposes.

Reuse, Donation, and Resale

- Equipment that is still functional but outdated may be:
 - **Donated** to community ICT training centers, schools, or NGOs.
 - **Repurposed** for less demanding administrative or training tasks.
 - **Sold** through approved public disposal procedures (in line with Public Procurement and Asset Disposal Act, 2015).

Responsibility

- The **ICT Manager** is responsible for coordinating the decommissioning process.
- The **Procurement and Finance departments** oversee asset valuation and disposal compliance.

- All staff must ensure that ICT resources are not abandoned, misused, or disposed of without proper authorization.

Internet Access and Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)

This policy defines the **responsible, ethical, and secure use of internet services** provided by Ruralnet ICT academy. It ensures that internet access supports **teaching, learning, research, and administration** while protecting users, systems, and the institution from misuse and security threats.

Its main purpose is to;

- To provide fair and reliable internet access for academic and institutional use.
- To guide students, staff, and visitors on **acceptable and unacceptable online behavior**.
- To protect the institution's ICT infrastructure, data, and reputation.
- To ensure compliance with **cyber laws, data protection regulations, and ICT ethics**.

Internet Access Provision

- Internet access is provided **primarily for academic, research, and administrative purposes**.
- Every facility laptop has been connected to the internet for learning purposes only.
- Other users such as walk-in clients who require browsing services are issued **unique login credentials** or Wi-Fi passwords and are responsible for their use.
- Bandwidth control is essential and is well maintained for clients who are connected and have subscribed to monthly plans depending on the rates.

Acceptable Use

Users are allowed to:

- Access online academic resources, journals, e-learning platforms, and educational websites.
- Use email, cloud tools, and collaboration platforms for academic and institutional communication.
- Download materials **approved and relevant** to coursework or institutional work upon authorization.
- Conduct research and innovation activities within legal and ethical boundaries.

Unacceptable Use

The following activities are strictly prohibited:

- Accessing or distributing **illegal, obscene, or offensive content**.
- Engaging in **cybercrime**, including hacking, phishing, malware distribution, or identity theft.
- Excessive use of bandwidth for non-academic activities (e.g., gaming, streaming, torrents).
- Using the internet for **harassment, bullying, hate speech, or defamation**.
- Downloading or sharing **pirated software, movies, or music**.
- Attempting to bypass network security, filters, or access controls.

Security and Privacy

- Users must not share login credentials or access another user's account.
- Personal data and institutional information must be handled in line with **data protection laws and only accessed by authorized staff**.
- The institution reserves the right to **monitor network traffic** to ensure security and policy compliance, while respecting user privacy.
- Users must report suspected **security incidents or misuse** to the ICT department immediately.

User Responsibilities

- Use the internet responsibly and ethically at all times.
- Protect devices from malware by avoiding unsafe websites and downloads.
- Log out of shared computers after use.
- Comply with all ICT-related policies, including cybersecurity and academic integrity policies.

Enforcement and Sanctions

- Violations of this policy results in:
 - Permanent suspension of internet access till course completion.
 - Disciplinary action under student or staff regulations.
 - Legal action in cases involving criminal activity.
- Repeat offenders must face **stricter penalties (expulsion from the institution)**

Network Security and Data Privacy Policy

This policy establishes measures to protect Ruralnet ICT college's **network infrastructure, information systems, and personal data** from unauthorized access, misuse, loss, or cyber threats. It ensures **confidentiality, integrity, and availability** of data in compliance with legal and ethical standards.

Network Security Measures

Access Control

- Network access is restricted to **authorized users only**.
- Strong authentication methods (password policies, multi-factor authentication where applicable) are enforced.
- User access rights are assigned based on **roles and responsibilities**.

Network Protection

- Firewalls, intrusion detection/prevention systems (IDS/IPS), and antivirus software are deployed and regularly updated.
- Networks are segmented (e.g., staff, students, guests) to reduce security risks.
- Regular vulnerability assessments and security audits are conducted.

Monitoring and Logging

- Network activity is monitored to detect **unauthorized access, attacks, or misuse**.
- System logs are maintained for audit and investigation purposes.
- Monitoring is conducted in accordance with privacy and legal requirements.

Data Privacy and Protection

Data Classification

- Data is classified as **public, internal, confidential, or sensitive**.
- Sensitive data (e.g., student records, staff files, examination data) receives the highest level of protection, and can only be accessed when authorized through staff login system in website.

Data Handling and Storage

- Personal and confidential data must be stored in **secure systems** with restricted access.
- Data encryption is used for sensitive data stored or transmitted over networks.
- Physical access to servers and data centers is strictly controlled.

Data Sharing

- Personal data is shared only with **authorized parties** and for legitimate purposes.
- Third-party access requires formal agreements and compliance with data protection standards.

User Responsibilities

- Users must protect login credentials and avoid sharing passwords.
- Personal devices connected to the network must meet **minimum security standards**.
- Users must immediately report **data breaches, suspicious activity, or security incidents**.
- Staff and students must comply with institutional policies on data handling and ICT ethics.

Training and Awareness

- Regular training is provided on **cybersecurity best practices and data privacy**.
- Awareness programs educate users on phishing, malware, and safe internet behavior.

ICT Support Services Policy (Helpdesk, Backups, and Repairs)

This policy defines how the college provides **technical support services** to ensure reliable, efficient, and uninterrupted use of ICT systems. It covers **user support, data protection, and equipment maintenance**, which are essential for effective teaching, learning, and administration. It aims;

- To provide timely and effective ICT support to students and staff.
- To minimize system downtime and disruption of academic and administrative activities.
- To protect institutional data through structured backup and recovery processes.
- To ensure ICT equipment is properly maintained and repaired.

ICT Helpdesk Services

Helpdesk Functions

- The ICT Helpdesk serves as the **first point of contact** for all ICT-related issues.
- Services provided include:
 - User account and password support
 - Software and system troubleshooting

- Network and internet connectivity issues
- Hardware and peripheral support
- Access to institutional systems (IMS, email, website)
- Graphic designing survives (poster designs, fliers/brochures)
- Website development and updates
- System structuring, designing/development and fault fixing.

Support Channels

- Support requests may be submitted through:
 - Walk-in helpdesk
 - Email or ticketing system
 - Telephone or internal communication platforms
- All requests are **logged, tracked, and prioritized** based on urgency and impact.

Response and Resolution

- Issues are categorized as **critical, high, medium, or low priority**.
- Target response times are defined to ensure service quality.
- Unresolved or complex issues are escalated to **senior ICT staff or external vendors**.

Data Backup and Recovery

Backup Procedures

- Regular backups are conducted for:
 - Student records (monthly through export to sheets)
 - Academic data and examinations
 - Financial and administrative systems
- Backups are performed on a **monthly basis**.
- Backup copies are stored securely on:
 - On-site servers (laptop 12)
 - Off-site locations and cloud storage (Ruralnet cloud account)

Data Recovery

- Data restoration is performed promptly in cases of:
 - System failure
 - Accidental deletion
 - Cyber incidents
- Backup systems are tested monthly to ensure reliability and completeness.

ICT Equipment Repairs and Maintenance

Repair Procedures

- All faulty ICT equipment must be reported to the ICT department immediately.
- Repairs are handled by:
 - In-house ICT technician for all fault types
 - Approved electrical technician
- Users are prohibited from attempting self-repairs on institutional equipment.

Preventive Maintenance

- Scheduled maintenance helps reduce breakdowns and prolong equipment lifespan.
- Maintenance activities include:
 - Hardware inspections and cleaning
 - Software updates and patches
 - Network equipment testing
 - Antivirus installation
 - Resource cleaning (blowing)

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
ICT Manager	Oversight of support services and resource allocation
Helpdesk Staff	Issue logging, troubleshooting, and user support
System Administrators	Backups, recovery, and server maintenance
Users	Prompt reporting of issues and responsible ICT use

Service Standards and Monitoring

- Service delivery is monitored through **helpdesk reports and user feedback**.
- Key performance indicators (KPIs) include response time, resolution time, and user satisfaction.
- Continuous improvement is encouraged through regular reviews.

Integration of ICT in Teaching, Learning, and Administration Policy

This policy provides a framework for the **effective use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT)** to enhance **instructional delivery, student learning outcomes, and administrative efficiency** within Ruralnet ICT Academy.

ICT Integration in Teaching

Digital Teaching Tools

- Instructors are encouraged to use:
 - Learning Management Systems (LMS) for course content, assignments, and assessments.
 - Multimedia tools (TCL display screen currently available).
 - Online collaboration tools (forums, email, video conferencing).
- Teaching methods support **blended and online learning** models.

Curriculum Enhancement

- ICT competencies are embedded into curricula across all programs.
- Courses emphasize **hands-on practical skills**, problem-solving, and innovation.
- Continuous review ensures alignment with **industry standards and emerging technologies**.

ICT Integration in Learning

Student Engagement

- Students access learning materials anytime through digital platforms (E-library).
- ICT supports **self-paced, collaborative, and student-centered learning** approaches.
- Online assessments and feedback improve learning outcomes.

Digital Literacy

- The institution promotes digital literacy skills such as:
 - Information search and evaluation
 - Ethical ICT use
 - Cybersecurity awareness
- Students are trained to use ICT tools responsibly and professionally.

ICT Integration in Administration

Digital Administrative Systems

- Core administrative processes are digitized, including:
 - Student admissions and registration
 - Examination and grading systems
 - Finance and payroll management
 - Human resource management
- Electronic document management systems improve efficiency and reduce paperwork.

Communication and Decision-Making

- Official communication is conducted through institutional email and portals.
- Data analytics and management systems support **evidence-based decision-making**.
- Automation reduces delays and improves service delivery.

Capacity Building and Support

- Regular training programs are provided for staff and students on:
 - Use of new ICT tools
 - E-learning methodologies
 - Administrative systems
- ICT support services ensure smooth adoption and usage.

Infrastructure and Security

- Adequate ICT infrastructure (networks, labs, servers) supports system integration.
- All ICT systems comply with **cybersecurity and data protection policies**.
- Regular system upgrades ensure reliability and scalability.

CHAPTER 7: FINANCE AND PROCUREMENT POLICY

This chapter outlines the principles, procedures, and controls governing **financial management and procurement** in Ruralnet ICT College. It ensures **transparency, accountability, value for money, and compliance** with applicable laws and institutional objectives.

Objective

- To ensure prudent and efficient use of financial resources.
- To guide fair, competitive, and transparent procurement of goods and services.
- To support academic delivery, ICT infrastructure development, and administrative operations.
- To ensure compliance with financial and procurement regulations.

Budget Preparation and Approval Process

Budget Preparation

- Budget preparation is conducted **after every 6 months** and is carried out by management and administrator/HR after collecting all requisition forms from departmental heads (ICT, accounting and administration)
- Each department prepares a **detailed budget proposal** outlining expected expenditures and justifications, including:
 - ICT infrastructure, software, and maintenance
 - Accounting requirement's and resources.
 - Staff remuneration and development
 - Student services and welfare
- Budget proposals must align with the available revenue.

Budget Review and Consolidation

- Departmental budgets are reviewed by the **management** for accuracy, feasibility, and compliance.
- Overlapping or non-essential expenditures are adjusted to ensure **cost-effectiveness and priority funding**.
- The reviewed departmental budgets are consolidated into a **draft institutional budget**.

Budget Approval

- Approval considers:

- Available financial resources
 - Institutional priorities and development plans
- Once approved, the budget becomes the **official financial guide** for the 6 months.

Financial Record-Keeping and Auditing

Financial Record-Keeping

- Ruralnet maintains **complete, accurate, and up-to-date financial records** for all transactions.
- Records include:
 - Receipts and payment vouchers
 - Invoices and delivery notes
 - Bank statements and cashbooks
 - Payroll records
 - Asset and inventory registers
 - LPOs
 - Requisition forms
 - Log sheets
- Financial records are prepared and stored using **accounting system** (manual records (books and papers) are also stored well).
- All records are supported by **original source documents** and properly authorized.
- Access to financial records is restricted to **authorized administrator/HR or manager** to prevent misuse or tampering.

Financial Auditing

- The college should conduct **quarterly internal audits** to:
 - Verify accuracy of financial records
 - Detect errors, fraud, or misuse of funds
- **External audits** are conducted annually by independent and qualified auditors.
- Auditors have full access to relevant financial records and systems.
- Audit reports are submitted to **management** for review.

Audit Follow-Up and Compliance

- Audit findings and recommendations are documented and addressed promptly.
- Management develops and implements **corrective action plans** for identified weaknesses.
- Continuous audit follow-up ensures improved financial controls and accountability.

Procurement Procedures (Tenders, Quotations, and Approvals)

Procurement Planning

- All procurement activities are planned in advance according to the need.
- Departments identify procurement needs and submit **formal requisitions** with clear specifications and justifications.
- The Procurement Unit (HR/administrator) verifies availability of funds before initiating the process.

Procurement Methods

i) Open Tendering

- Used for **high-value or complex procurements**.
- Tenders are publicly advertised to ensure open competition.
- Tender documents clearly outline specifications, evaluation criteria, and submission deadlines.
- An evaluation committee assesses bids based on **technical compliance, price, and vendor capability**.

ii) Request for Quotations (RFQ)

- Applied for **low to medium-value purchases**.
- At least **three competitive quotations** are obtained from qualified suppliers.
- Selection is based on price, quality, delivery time, and supplier reliability.

iii) Direct Procurement

- Used only in exceptional cases, such as:
 - Emergency purchases
 - Single-source or proprietary items
- Requires **written justification and management approval**.

Approval Process

- All procurement requests must receive **prior approval** based on delegated authority levels.
- Approvals are required at key stages:
 - Requisition approval
 - Supplier selection approval
 - Purchase order or contract approval
- No procurement may proceed without **budget confirmation and authorization**.

Purchase Orders and Contracts

- Approved procurements are formalized through **purchase orders or contracts**.
- Documents specify quantities, prices, delivery timelines, warranties, and payment terms.
- Contracts are signed only by **authorized officers**.

Delivery, Inspection, and Acceptance

- Goods and services are inspected upon delivery to confirm compliance with specifications.
- An inspection and acceptance report is prepared before payment is processed.
- Defective or non-compliant items are rejected and/or returned.

Documentation and Record-Keeping

- All procurement records are properly filed, including:
 - Requisitions
 - Quotations or tender documents
 - Evaluation reports
 - Approval records
 - Delivery and payment documents
- Records are retained for audit and accountability purposes.

Asset Management and Inventory Control

Asset Identification and Registration

- All assets acquired by the college are **formally recorded** in an asset and inventory register.
- Each asset is assigned a **unique identification number or asset tag**.
- Asset records include:
 - Asset description and serial number
 - Date of acquisition and cost
 - Location and assigned user/department
 - Current condition and warranty details

Asset Custody and Use

- Assets are issued to departments or individuals under **custodial responsibility**.
- Assets must be used **strictly for institutional purposes**.
- Transfer of assets between departments requires **authorization and documentation**.
- Users are responsible for safeguarding assets against loss, damage, or misuse.

Inventory Control

- Regular **physical stock-taking and verification** is conducted (at least annually).
- Inventory records are reconciled with physical counts to identify discrepancies.
- Losses, damages, or shortages are reported immediately and investigated.
- Obsolete, damaged, or idle assets are flagged for **repair, reallocation, or disposal**.

Maintenance and Depreciation

- Assets are maintained through **scheduled servicing and repairs** (monthly) to extend useful life.
- Maintenance and depreciation records support financial reporting and asset replacement planning.

Disposal of Assets

- Disposal of assets follows the approved **Asset Disposal and Decommissioning Policy**.
- Disposal methods include resale, donation, recycling, or destruction.
- All disposals require **management approval** and proper documentation.
- Disposed assets are removed from the asset register.

Resource Mobilization (Grants, Donations, and Income-Generating Projects)

Purpose of Resource Mobilization

- To supplement institutional income and reduce over-reliance on student fees.
- To support development of **ICT infrastructure, research, innovation, and student programs**.
- To enhance institutional sustainability and competitiveness.

Grants and External Funding

- The college actively seeks **grants from government agencies, development partners, NGOs, and international organizations**.
- Grant proposals are developed in alignment with:
 - Institutional strategic goals
 - Academic and ICT development priorities
- Grant funds are:
 - Used strictly for the approved purpose
 - Properly accounted for and reported to donors
- Compliance with donor conditions and reporting timelines is mandatory.

Donations and Sponsorships

- The institution may receive **financial or material donations** from individuals, corporations, alumni, or partner organizations.
- All donations must be:
 - Declared and formally acknowledged
 - Recorded in financial and asset registers
- Donations must not compromise the institution's **independence, ethics, or academic integrity**.
- Sponsored projects and facilities are managed transparently and in line with institutional values.

Income-Generating Projects

- The college may establish **income-generating activities (IGAs)** such as:
 - Short professional ICT courses and certifications
 - Consultancy and technical support services
 - Software development and innovation hubs
 - Commercial use of ICT facilities

- IGAs must be:
 - Approved by management
 - Financially viable and legally compliant
- Income generated is:s
 - Properly accounted for
 - Reinvested into academic programs, infrastructure, and student services

Oversight and Accountability

- Resource mobilization activities are overseen by **management and finance committees**.
- Regular financial and performance reports are prepared.
- Audits ensure transparency, compliance, and effective utilization of resources.